

Effects Panel, History, Timeline, Clips and Audio Meter. All of these panels can be toggled on and off like any window and can be customised from the Menu Bar below the Title Bar through a Tools or Preferences menu option.

The Project Panel is usually present at the very top-left of the software window and can be spotted with a handy thumbnail of the active project. The panel also includes the most essential project information like - title, resolution, runtime, frame rate, audio properties and others. Within the Project Panel is also an organisational space sometimes known as the Bin where you can consolidate all the media files you will need in one space. They can be organised in folders and labelled as needed.

Below the Project Panel is the Media Browser which is a miniature Explorer window that shows the computers directories and files. You can navigate it to import the project files to the Project Panel using simple drag and drop. The Media Browser also has the Information Panel which concisely gives you the properties of the files visible and the History Panel allows you to see the changes that have been made. The Effects Panel is where all the different effect tools are available. They are organised in categories and can be dragged and dropped onto the clips in the Timeline based on where and how they wish to be used. A Fade Out effect or a Flare Light effect for example can be dropped at the end of a clip and will create the labelled effect. Most editing software come with a host of different effects but there exist specialised third party plugins such as those by Boris VFX that can provide a much higher degree of visual splendor.

Next to the Project Panel is the Source Monitor where you can quickly play and view the raw footage that is in your Bin. It may or may not display the running time of the footage known as the Time Code but it is an option that can always be toggled on or off from the Menu Bar. This space is helpful to view large video segments while marking down the Time Codes for where you would like to make your cuts. The desired cuts can be marked using In and Out buttons within the Source Panel or via keyboard shortcuts. Once marked the desired clip can be dragged and dropped into the Timeline.

Within the Source Monitor Panel is another tabbed window called the Effects Control and is where all the detailed editing takes place, from adding transition effects to changing colour temperature. Whichever clip is selected in the Timeline is activated here for editing. The Audio Mixer in the next sub-window has a similar function with respect to audio properties and is used to make detailed changes in any selected clips audio properties. The Audio Meter is located at the lower right side next to the Timeline and